

music festival

Traditional Treat

DELHI The three-day Shriram Shankarlal Music Festival beginning February 29 is a finale to the music season before the long hot summer begins. This festival is an acid test for musicians because the audience has high expectations from it. The genesis of the festival was at a small concert when India gained Independence. It was just an informal gathering of musicians at Sumitra Charatram's house at Delhi's Curzon Road where they gave an artistic interpretation of freedom. Among the early performers have been Ustad Hafeez Ali Khan, Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, Pandit Ravi Shankar and Ali Akbar Khan.

"Ever since the inception of the Shriram Bhartiya Kala Kendra in 1952, we have been holding concerts every year. Initially the festival was called *Jhankar*. We have presented stalwarts as well as young and promising musicians," says Shobha Deepak Singh, vice-chairperson of the

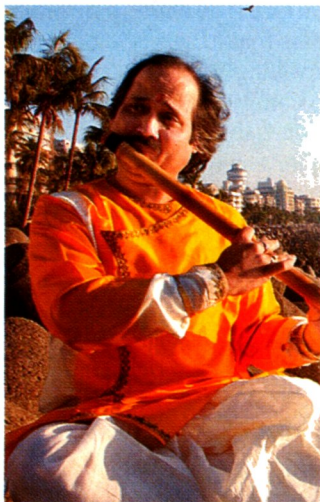
Kendra. What is different this year is that instead of three artistes performing in the evening, only two will perform with the exception being a morning recital by Veena Shahasrabudhe from Gwalior on Sunday, a rare treat indeed. The line-up of artistes is impressive—Shahid Parvez (sitar), Pandit Jasraj (vocal), Ronu Mazumdar (flute), Rajan and Sajan Mishra (vocal), Ayaan Ali Khan (sarod) and Rashid Khan (vocal).

The Kendra will also release a limited edition CD series called *Jhankar*, conceived by Singh. "While we were documenting the recordings in our archives, it occurred to us to share some of these treasures with *rasiks* and release the collection at the festival. Care has been taken not to include ragas that are already available in the market," she says.

For the new generation that is more attuned to fusion and neo-musicians, the recordings testify the old masters' style and genius. The limited edition albums will be on sale at the festival and later at the Kendra. At Kamani Auditorium.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

MELODY MAKERS: Ayaan Ali Khan (left); Mazumdar



art exhibition

Triple Triumph

MUMBAI Excavation: Memory/Myth/Membrane depicts the detailed drama in the works of Nalini Malani, Jayashree Chakravarty and Reena Kallat. Dabbling in much more than just art, each of their works has dealt with a layered approach to life and in turn, art. Malani portrays the image of the sexualised female body and the de-gendered woman in the form of a mutant. But the details in her paintings are not elements that add up to a tidy whole; each is a story unto itself that the audience recognises but does not necessarily understand. Chakravarty's white and silver grey landscapes are robust and muscular depictions with an uncanny ability to stretch into infinity. Kallat's paintings and sculpture-installations are representations of the human body under perennial siege. To control this, she draws and shapes objects—like dense foliage, fruits and flowers—to reign in the symbols of systemic violence. At Art Musings till March 31.

by Swati Mathur

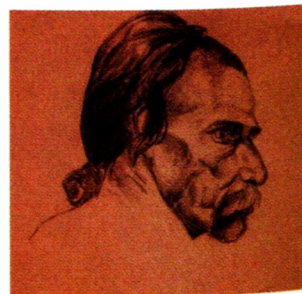
MULTI-LAYERED: Works by Kallat (left) and Malani



art

Mofussil Images

DELHI Chowdhary Satyanarayana Patnaik's works present a slice of life-like mofussil India, highlighting his love for village folk and a bucolic atmosphere. His drawings and sculptures capture real expressions on the faces of villagers. "For me, sculpture is very much a physical pleasure. It's like



Patnaik draws rural India hunting for that vital image," Patnaik once said. At Gallerie Romain Rolland. From February 21 to 29.